

AI Tutoring Session & Parent Communication Assistant

1. Job to Be Done

The agent will act as a personal assistant for my part-time tutoring work. Its main job is to supervise **parent communication and scheduled tutoring sessions**, reducing the amount of manual checking I need to do before, during, and after a lesson.

The agent will have two main responsibilities:

1. Manage scheduling-related parent emails
2. Monitor scheduled tutoring sessions for student attendance

For scheduling, I will provide the agent with my regular tutoring schedule and examples of previous emails. When a parent emails requesting a change to a scheduled session, the agent will identify the requested change and compare it with my available schedule. It will then ask me for confirmation before any change is communicated to the parent. Once I approve the response, the agent will draft an email using the tone and structure of my previous tutoring emails, either confirming the new time or offering an alternative.

For session monitoring, the agent will use my scheduled tutoring sessions as triggers. When a session is due to begin, it will check whether I have started the Zoom meeting and whether the student has joined.

If the student has joined, the monitoring workflow stops.

If the student has not joined:

- At approximately 5 minutes, the agent will notify me and, if configured for automatic sending, send a polite email to the parent explaining that I am currently in the Zoom meeting.
- At approximately 10 minutes, it will repeat the notification if there has been no student attendance and no relevant response from the parent.
- At 15 minutes, the agent will prepare the final email. stating that I waited for 15 minutes and that, according to my stated tutoring policy, the session may be charged and a makeup session can be arranged within two weeks. I will approve this final action before it is sent and before the meeting is ended.

2. User and Usage Frequency

The primary user is me, as a part-time tutor.

The agent may be used:

- Before every scheduled tutoring session
- During every scheduled tutoring session
- Whenever a parent requests a schedule change
- After sessions where attendance or scheduling issues occur

The expected frequency is several times per week, depending on the number of tutoring sessions.

The goal is not to replace my involvement in tutoring. Instead, the agent should remove repetitive administrative work so that I can focus on teaching.

3. Tools and Data Needed

1. Email:

- a. Purpose: Read parent scheduling emails, identify requests, and draft or send appropriate responses.
- b. Data required:
 - i. Parent emails
 - ii. Previous tutoring email examples
 - iii. Student/session information contained in relevant emails
 - iv. My preferred email tone and wording
 - v. Approved tutoring/no-show policy
- c. Access plan: The agent will use Gmail through n8n's Gmail integration. Email access will be restricted to the account used for tutoring communication.

The agent should only process relevant tutoring emails rather than my entire personal inbox where possible.

2. Calendar:

- a. Purpose: Identify upcoming tutoring sessions and their scheduled times.
- b. Data required:
 - i. Student/session name
 - ii. Date and time
 - iii. Zoom meeting information
 - iv. Recurring tutoring schedule
- c. Access plan: Use Google Calendar through n8n. Calendar data will be used primarily to trigger the session-monitoring workflow.

3. Zoom

- a. Purpose: Determine whether the tutoring meeting has started and whether the student has joined.
- b. Data required:
 - i. Meeting ID
- c. Access plan: Use the Zoom API/webhooks if available through the chosen implementation. If full participant monitoring cannot be implemented within the project scope, the MVP will be reduced to monitoring the meeting start and using a manual confirmation for student attendance.

This fallback is important because the core objective is the communication workflow rather than building a complete Zoom monitoring system.

4. Draft Agent Instructions

The agent should follow these general instructions:

- You are my tutoring administration assistant. Your job is to monitor tutoring schedules, identify relevant parent communication, and help manage attendance-related communication.
- For scheduling requests, identify the requested date/time and compare it with my provided availability. Never confirm a schedule change without my approval.
- When drafting emails, use the tone and structure of my previous tutoring emails: polite, professional, concise, and friendly.
- During tutoring sessions, monitor whether the scheduled session has started and whether the student has joined. Do not send repeated messages if the parent has already communicated a relevant reason for the absence.
- At 5 and 10 minutes after the scheduled start time, notify me of the student's absence and prepare the appropriate parent communication if required.
- At 15 minutes, prepare the no-show message based on my tutoring policy.
- Never independently make a new financial policy, change the stated cancellation/no-show policy, or make exceptions to the policy.
- Never terminate a Zoom meeting or send a message stating that a session will be charged without my final approval.
- If information is ambiguous, stop and ask me rather than guessing.

5. Evaluation Cases

The following cases will be tested before and during implementation.

<i>Test Case ID</i>	<i>Input</i>	<i>Expected Result</i>
TC-01	A session is scheduled for 4:00 PM. I start the Zoom meeting and the student joins at 4:02 PM.	The agent recognises that the student has joined and stops the attendance-monitoring workflow.
TC-02	A session starts at 4:00 PM. I am in Zoom, but the student has not joined by 4:05 PM.	The agent identifies that the student is absent, notifies me, and prepares/sends the appropriate 5-minute parent communication according to the configured workflow.
TC-03	The student has not joined by 4:05 PM, but the parent emailed at 4:03 PM explaining that the student is having an emergency.	The agent recognises the relevant parent communication and does not send a generic "I am waiting in the meeting" message without considering the new information. It should

		notify me and pause the automated attendance communication.
TC-04	A parent emails asking to move Wednesday's lesson from 5:00 PM to 6:00 PM.	The agent identifies the requested change, checks my available schedule, and asks me for confirmation before communicating a final answer. It then drafts a response using the style of my previous emails.
TC-05	I start the Zoom meeting at the scheduled time, the student never joins, and the parent does not respond.	At 15 minutes, the agent alerts me and prepares the no-show email explaining the waiting period, the applicable tutoring policy, and the possibility of a makeup session within two weeks. It does not independently make the final billing decision, send the final message, or terminate the meeting without my approval.
TC-06	A parent asks, "Can we move next week's lesson to the afternoon?"	The agent should not assume a specific time. It should identify the request as ambiguous and ask the parent for clarification rather than selecting a time itself.

6. Risks and Guardrails

<i>Risk</i>	<i>Guardrail</i>
Accidental or incorrect emails - The agent could misunderstand a parent's request or send an inappropriate response.	Schedule changes and unusual parent requests require my approval before being sent.
Incorrect attendance detection - A student may have joined using a different account/name, or the Zoom information may be unavailable.	The agent should treat uncertain attendance information as unknown rather than assuming the student is absent.
Incorrect billing communication - Automatically telling a parent that they will be charged could create a financial or relationship issue.	The agent can prepare the message, but I must approve the final no-show/billing communication.

Irreversible meeting actions - Ending a Zoom meeting automatically could terminate a session that should continue.	The agent must never terminate a meeting automatically in the MVP. It should notify me and let me make the decision.
Privacy - Parent and student emails contain personal information.	Only relevant tutoring emails and scheduling information should be processed. The agent should not access unrelated personal emails unless necessary.
Hallucinated information - The agent could invent availability, policies, or previous agreements.	The agent may only use the provided schedule, previous emails, and explicitly provided tutoring policy. If the required information is unavailable, it must ask me instead of guessing.

7. Platform Choice

I will use *n8n* because this agent depends heavily on scheduled triggers and integrations rather than only conversational reasoning.

The workflow can connect: Google Calendar → *n8n* → Zoom → Gmail → AI model → Human approval

This makes it more as the agent needs to perform actions at specific times and interact with external services.

8. MVP Scope

To keep the project achievable within approximately 10 build hours, the first version will focus on:

1. Reading relevant parent scheduling emails
2. Detecting schedule-change requests
3. Checking the tutoring calendar
4. Generating responses using previous email examples
5. Requiring approval for schedule changes
6. Triggering session monitoring from calendar events
7. Detecting or recording student attendance
8. Sending/creating the 5- and 10-minute attendance communication
9. Preparing the 15-minute no-show message
10. Requiring human approval for the final communication

Automatic Zoom meeting termination and fully autonomous billing decisions are explicitly out of scope for the MVP.

The success of the agent will be measured by whether it correctly identifies scheduling and attendance situations, reduces repetitive administrative work, produces appropriate parent communication, and avoids taking consequential actions without approval.